HOW TO USE

AirWhisper

A practical guide to the Apple Watch features and the iPhone companion app.

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This PDF follows the How to Use page on the AirWhisper website. It is designed to read on screen or print.

01 Apple Watch setup

Three watchOS settings presented on the website as the starting setup for AirWhisper.

Turn on AssistiveTouch and Hand Gestures

Why: Lets patients control the Watch using hand gestures without touching small screen buttons.

Apple's AssistiveTouch guide

01	Open Settings on the Apple Watch or the Watch app on iPhone.
02	Go to Accessibility.
03	Select AssistiveTouch and turn it on.
04	Open Hand Gestures and turn them on.

Tip: Recommended shortcuts: Pinch moves forward; Double Pinch moves back; Clench selects; Double Clench opens quick actions.

Turn off Wrist Detection

Why: Tremors, contractures, or resting the arm on a bedrail or table can make watchOS think the Watch was taken off. Turning Wrist Detection off helps keep it awake.

01	Open the Watch app on iPhone or Settings on the Apple Watch.
02	Tap Passcode.
03	Scroll down to Wrist Detection.
04	Turn Wrist Detection off and confirm.

Tip: Without this change, a passcode prompt may appear during a message.

Set Wake Duration to 70 seconds

Why: The default screen timeout may be too short to finish a stroke or review a letter.

01	Open Settings on the Apple Watch.
02	Tap Display & Brightness.
03	Open Wake Duration.
04	Select Wake for 70 Seconds.

Tip: A longer wake duration gives more time to complete a message.

02 Quick Phrases

Pre-saved sentences for messages the person may need often.

HELP is pinned first. Once you use a phrase, it automatically promotes for faster access next time. AirWhisper supports up to 10 phrases. The least-used phrase is replaced when the list is full, with an alert.

Phrase sync

Phrases sync to the Apple Watch over Bluetooth. Sign in with Apple enables supported AirWhisper data to sync through iCloud across devices using the same Apple ID. Google and email sign-in keep data on this device in this build.

Add a phrase

01	Open AirWhisper on the iPhone and go to Home.
02	Tap Add new phrase or open How to Use, then Quick Phrases, then Manage Quick Phrases.
03	Enter the phrase and tap Add.

Use a phrase on the Watch

01	Open AirWhisper on the Apple Watch.
02	Choose the phrase to communicate.
03	On the Actions screen, choose Speak Aloud or Send To. Choose Cancel to return without taking action.

03 / Three ways to communicate

AIR GESTURE / LEFT WRIST

AirWrite - draw in the air

AirWrite recognizes uppercase letters drawn in the air. Draw with your left arm in one fluid motion. The letter is recognized and added to the message.

01	Tap Start, or use the configured clench gesture. Voice Guidance announces Start Recording.
02	Trace one capital letter in the air with your left arm.
03	Tap Stop, or use the configured clench gesture. The recognized letter is spoken and added to the message.

03 / Three ways to communicate - continued

WRIST TILT / ROLL AND PITCH

OrientWrite - tilt the wrist

Use wrist tilts to move a cursor across a virtual canvas and trace a letter. Sensitivity changes how far the cursor moves for a given tilt.

01	Open Writing Modes on the Watch and choose OrientWrite.
02	Tilt left or right to move horizontally; tilt forward or back to move vertically.
03	Tap Start, trace the letter with the cursor, and tap Stop.
04	Use Backspace to remove the last letter, or tap Done to continue to Actions.

HANDS-FREE / QUICK SPEAK ONLY

Surface Tap - tap a nearby surface

Tap a nearby surface such as a table, bedrail, chair arm, or your leg. The Watch detects vibration through the wrist. A green outline indicates the focused item; a haptic response indicates a recognized tap.

01	Rest the wrist comfortably on a surface.
02	A single tap moves to the next phrase and may speak it when Voice Guidance is on.
03	A double tap opens Actions for the focused phrase.

Surface Tap is available on Quick Speak. AirWrite and OrientWrite use their own controls.

04 Actions after composing a message

After creating text with AirWrite or OrientWrite, tap Done to open Actions.

Action	What happens
Speak Aloud	The Watch speaks the message through its speaker. This works even when Voice Guidance is off.
Send To	Opens available contacts. Selecting a contact sends the message as an SMS through AirWhisper's cloud service.
Save as Phrase	Adds a message created with AirWrite or OrientWrite to Quick Speak.
Cancel	Returns to the previous screen without speaking, sending, or saving.

05 / Alphabet stroke guide

Practice continuous single-stroke arm movements with starter words to achieve immediate, 100% recognition accuracy. Draw from the shoulder and elbow with your left wrist.

The interactive A-Z stroke guide on the website includes animated examples. The reference below lists each letter's starting point, stroke motion, and coaching tip.

Letter	Starts	Stroke motion	Coaching tip
A	Bottom left	Up diagonal to apex; down to bottom right; loop back across center bar	One continuous triangular motion, no lifting
B	Top left	Down stem; round top loop; round bottom loop	Keep the two loops distinct
C	Top right	Up slightly; broad left arc; down right	Broad elbow arcs prevent flat curves
D	Top left	Down stem; arc right; full bottom closure	Classifier checks the full bottom loop
E	Top right	Top bar; down spine; bottom bar; middle bar	Keep the spine vertical
F	Top right	Top bar; down spine; middle crossbar	Like E, but stop after the middle bar
G	Top right	Counter-clockwise C; sweep up on right; hook inward	Accentuate the horizontal hook
H	Top left	Down left stem; down right stem; center bar	Draw as fluid double uprights
I	Top center	Straight vertical drop	A crisp, decisive stroke works best
J	Top right	Sweep left across top; down center; hook left at bottom	Make the bottom hook prominent
K	Top left	Down stem; diagonal right; diagonal down-right	Emphasize the junction
L	Top left	Down stroke; sharp corner; horizontal right	Pause at the corner to register the angle
M	Bottom left	Up left; down center; up right; down right	Sharp high peaks

05 Alphabet stroke guide - continued

Continue the reference from N through Z.

Letter	Starts	Stroke motion	Coaching tip
N	Bottom left	Up left stem; sharp diagonal; up right stem	Distinct diagonal descent
O	Top center	Full counter-clockwise circle back to start	Big, wide circular sweep
P	Bottom left	Up stem; top half-loop back to stem	Do not draw a lower loop; this distinguishes D
Q	Top center	Full O circle; short diagonal tail at bottom right	Make the tail flick distinct
R	Bottom left	Up stem; round top loop; diagonal leg down-right	Keep the leg extended
S	Top right	Curve left; diagonal center; curve right under	Fluid serpentine, no mid-stops
T	Top left	Horizontal bar; return center; down stem	Keep the top bar wide
U	Top left	Down left; round bottom cup; up right	Keep bottom rounded, not pointed
V	Top left	Down diagonal to center; up diagonal to right	Make the bottom junction sharp
W	Top left	Down; up center; down; up right	Like inverted M; keep valleys sharp
X	Top left	Diagonal down-right; diagonal from top right down-left	Distinct cross-intersection
Y	Top left	Two short diagonals into center; down tail	Keep the tail centered
Z	Top left	Horizontal right; sharp diagonal down-left; horizontal right	Exaggerate the parallel horizontals

06 iPhone companion app

Use the iPhone app to manage settings and information used by the Watch.

Watch Settings

Motion sensitivity adjusts OrientWrite cursor movement. Voice Guidance and Tap Detector can also be changed here; settings sync over Bluetooth.

Manage Quick Phrases

Add common needs such as Please adjust my pillow, I need suction, Yes, and No.

My People

Contacts available from Send To on the Watch.

Message History

Review sent messages with recipient, text, and timestamp.

07 Troubleshooting

Common symptoms and the fixes shown on the website.

Watch screen goes black while drawing

Cause: Wake Duration is set to the default (15 seconds).
Fix: Settings > Display & Brightness > Wake Duration > Wake for 70 Seconds.

Passcode prompt appears during arm movement

Cause: Wrist Detection is on and the sensor lost contact during tremor.
Fix: Settings > Passcode > turn Wrist Detection off.

Letters are consistently misrecognized

Cause: The Watch is worn on the right hand.
Fix: AirWrite requires the left wrist. Move the Watch to your left wrist.

Surface Tap does not detect taps

Cause: The tap may be too light, or calibration may not match the surface.
Fix: Tap Recalibrate on the Watch and perform three firmer baseline taps.

SMS fails to send

Cause: The iPhone may be disconnected, or the number format may be invalid.
Fix: Check Wi-Fi or cellular data and use contact numbers with an international + prefix.

08 Using AirWhisper together

Practical ways to support someone who is learning to use AirWhisper. These are usage suggestions, not additional app features.

Before a communication session

- Check that the Watch is charged and comfortably fitted.
- Open AirWhisper on the Watch and make sure it reaches Quick Speak.
- If the person plans to send an SMS, check internet access and make sure the iPhone app has been opened and synchronized.
- Check that the intended interaction method is available. Tap Detector must be off for AirWrite and OrientWrite to appear on Quick Speak.
- Make sure the person knows how to return to the communication screen or ask for help.

Help the person practise

- Start with familiar Quick Speak phrases such as Yes, No, and Help.
- Give the person time to select a phrase and choose an action.
- When they are comfortable, practise a short message with AirWrite or OrientWrite.
- Practise Surface Tap calibration and navigation if the person plans to use it.
- Try AssistiveTouch gestures if hand-gesture navigation is preferred.
- Use the method the person finds most comfortable and dependable.

During communication

- Allow enough time to select or compose a message. Do not assume what the person intends to say before they finish.
- If a letter is missed, allow them to try again or use another available method.
- Listen carefully when Speak Aloud is used.
- Check that the intended contact is selected and wait for the Message Sent confirmation before assuming the SMS was sent.

After communication

- Use Message History on the iPhone to review messages successfully sent from the Watch.
- Keep the iPhone and Watch nearby when synchronization is needed.
- Review settings if the person reports that cursor movement, spoken guidance, or tap navigation is uncomfortable.